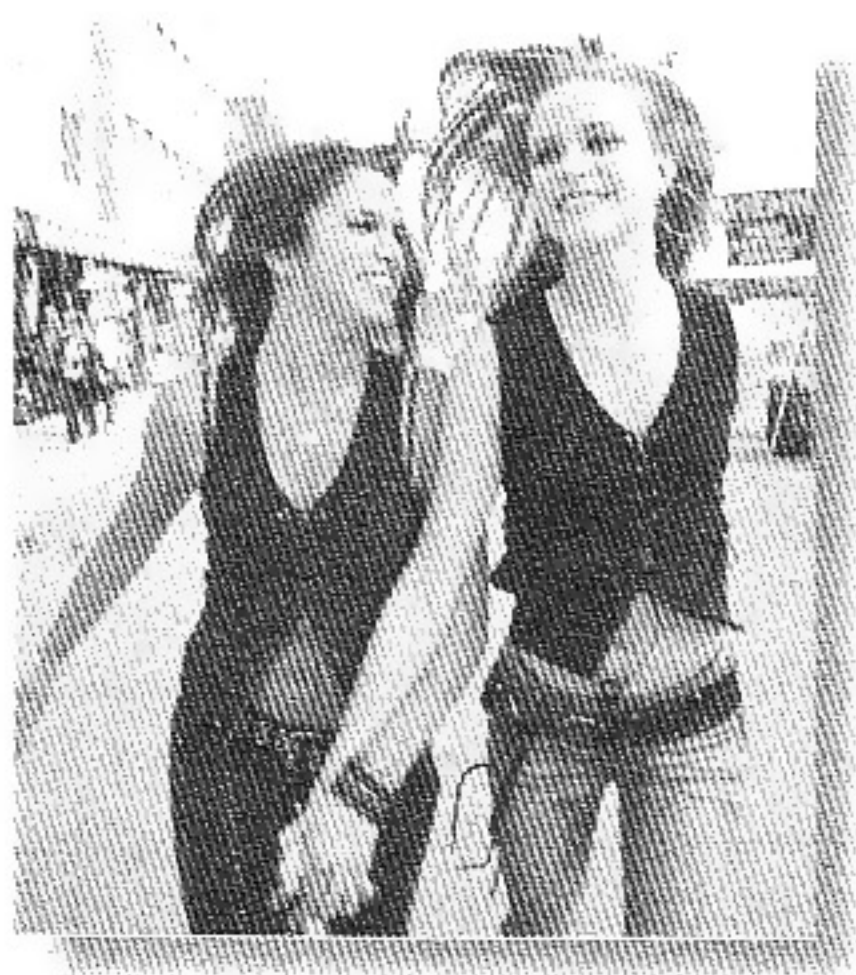


18 THE YOUNG AND THEIR WORLD



Youth is the best time to be rich and the best time to be poor.

Euripides

The first half of our lives is ruined by our parents and the second half by our children.

Clarence Darrow

□ VOCABULARY INPUT

Dealing with this topic you will come across the following vocabulary. Read it and look up the unknown words in your dictionary.

- **young people:** teenagers, teens, adolescents, youngsters, minors
- **physical appearance of the young:** going through physical changes (*boys:* facial hair, building muscle mass, deeper voice; *girls:* breasts enlarge, hips widen), piercing, tattoo, baggy/shabby/casual/tight clothes, spiky/coloured/highlighted hair
- **characteristics of the young:** searching for a unique identity, identifying with role-models, obsession with own appearance; independent, unstable, worried, puzzled, careless, frustrated, easygoing, reluctant, inhibited, amicable, cheerful, confused, curious, moody, stubborn, self-reliant, self-aware, rebellious, reckless, struggling
- **(legal) rights of the young:** voting, smoking, drinking alcohol, having a driving licence, getting married, working
- **common problems of the young:** eating disorders (bulimia, anorexia, overeating, obesity), mental disorders, schizophrenia, social/education/peer pressure, gambling, drinking, drugs addiction, unemployment, bullying, violence, vandalism, teenage pregnancy
- **activities/relationship with peers:** to make friends, to hang out with friends, to fall in love, to have a date, giving/going to parties, to get on with peers
- **relationship with adults/parents:** less emotionally bound to parents, conflicts, arguments, fights, misunderstandings, broken relationships
- **generation gap:** parents' approach: overprotective/authoritarian/liberal/democratic, different priorities, life expectations, tension
- **the future of the young:** desire for freedom and independence, uncertainty, fears, worries

□ DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

Before reading the text, discuss the following questions in class.

1. What is it like to be a teenager?
2. What are the most common worries and fears of young people?
3. Name at least three good and three bad things about being young.
4. What do you know about the legal rights of the young in Slovakia and in other countries?

5. Who are usually idols for the young?
6. What are common after-school activities of your peers?
7. Why is there tension between some parents and their teenage children?
8. What do you imagine a "normal" relationship is between parents and their teenage children?
9. How do you think you will raise your own children? In an authoritarian, democratic or a liberal way? Explain.
10. How should our society support the young?

□ TEXT

Read the texts below in silence. Check the meaning of the words in bold and answer the questions below.

PHYSICAL CHANGES IN ADOLESCENTS

Adolescence is a **stage** of development between childhood and **adulthood** when a person is biologically adult. His/her physical and psychological development is almost **complete** but emotionally he/she is not fully **mature**. People from the age of thirteen to the age of nineteen are called "teenagers" because their age ends in "teen" in English. During puberty, most children **go through** dramatic physical **changes**, which often begin between the ages of nine and thirteen. Girls usually go through this stage earlier than boys. As puberty **progresses**, levels of sex hormones (testosterone and oestrogen) rise. This causes changes in **secondary sex characteristics** which **distinguish** the two sexes. Boys grow more **facial hair**, greater **muscle mass** and their voices deepen, girls' breasts **enlarge** and their **hips widen**.

1. How are adolescence and puberty defined in the text above?
2. What physical changes do teenage boys and girls undergo?

MENTAL CHANGES IN ADOLESCENTS

Adolescents also change mentally. Their emotional life is much more intensive than before. Young people often feel **unstable** and look for **security**. Love and friendship become the most important **values**. During adolescence, young people often **search for** their own **unique identity**. There is also a greater probability for them of developing **eating disorders** including anorexia or bulimia. The first symptoms of anorexia are: **vomiting** in secret, **obsession** with weight, fanatical exercising and rapid **weight loss**. **Sufferers** of bulimia **overeats** and afterwards they vomit up everything **in order to** be satisfied that they ate something but at the same time without **putting on weight**.

3. Why are the emotional lives of the young so intensive?
4. What are the symptoms of anorexia and bulimia?

IDOLS VS. AUTHORITIES

At this age, sports players, rock stars and film and television performers (e. g. reality show stars) become role models for them. Young people are often **obsessed with** their appearance. They follow the fashion trends closely and always want to be “in”. They have similar interests. They identify themselves with others, but at the same time they want to be different and develop their own individuality. Young people, in general, do not **trust the authorities** and tend to risk more. At this age, they are **under pressure** because they usually start and complete their secondary education and have to decide about their future career. They are less emotionally **bound to** their parents and prefer relationships with their **peers**. Most of them would like to start their own independent lives but are still financially **dependent on** their parents.

5. Why do the young imitate their role models?
6. What is the attitude of the young towards the authorities?

ADULTHOOD – A SOCIAL PHENOMENON

Young people often **struggle to fit in** with society. **Unemployment** is a fundamental problem **faced** by young people today. Many of them experience problems in **obtaining** jobs. This often causes financial worries and frustration. Unstable emotions or a lack of **emotional intelligence** among some adolescents may also **lead them to juvenile crime**. Vandalism and violence **based on** racism are, unfortunately, very frequent in this age group. Groups of youngsters with **racial prejudices** regularly provoke conflicts in many countries. **Addiction**, such as **to** alcohol, drugs and gambling, is another **consequence** of frustration, family conflicts or other teenage problems.

The **age of majority**, the age at which a person has full **legal rights**, differs from culture to culture. In each country, there are different age limits for driving a car, getting married or buying cigarettes. In Slovakia, adulthood is thought to begin when someone turns 18. From then on, the young are **considered** to be **responsible for** their actions. They are allowed to drive, buy alcohol and cigarettes and are **eligible** to vote. Marriage of the young under 18 must be **approved** by a court and with parental **consent**. Early teenage **pregnancy** can have a negative effect on a girl's body and it often leads to her leaving education. Teenagers are also not emotionally mature enough or financially independent enough to **bring up** children.

7. What kinds of social problems that young people face are mentioned in the text above?
8. Which legal rights do young people have in Slovakia when they turn 18?

GENERATION GAP

This **age of revolt** often leads to conflicts between the generations. This is known as the generation gap. Young people are **eager** to become adult, but at the same time have **doubts** about **taking on** adult responsibilities and freedom. They think that their parents care too much and are **overprotective**. Children often have different life **expectations** than their

parents do. All this creates **tension** between parents and their children. Older and younger people often do not understand each other because of their different experiences, opinions, habits and behaviour. They differ in clothing and hairstyles but also in more important **matters**, such as opinions on drug use and politics for example. Nowadays, many parents have less and less time for their children, who become mature and independent earlier than they did before. There are families in which children and parents do not talk about problems. Such children often feel isolated. In **extreme cases**, they run away from home thinking that the problem will be solved this way. They also run away because they are **neglected**, stressed out, verbally or physically **abused** or sometimes **kicked out**. When children or teenagers cannot talk to their parents, they should try to **address** a friend or someone they trust. In every country there are people whose job is to help kids and teenagers with problems. Children can talk to child **welfare workers** in person or call **help lines**.

9. What is the generation gap caused by?

10. According to the text, how do young people and their parents solve their problems in extreme cases?

□ VOCABULARY LIST

to abuse [ə'bjʊ:s] – zneužívať

addiction (to) [ə'dɪkʃn] – závislosť (na)

to address – osloviť, obrátiť sa na

adulthood – dospelosť

age of majority [mə'dʒɔrəti] – vek dospelosti

age of revolt – vek vzbury, protestu

to approve – schváliť

based on – založený na

bound (to) – viazaný (na), spätý (s)

to bring up – vychovávať

complete – úplný, ukončený

consent – súhlas

consequence [kɒnsɪkwəns] – dôsledok

to consider – považovať

dependent (on) – závislý (na)

to distinguish [dɪ'stɪŋɡwɪʃ] – rozlišovať

doubt [daʊt] – pochybnosť

eager [i:gə(r)] – nedočkavý, chtivý

eating disorder – porucha stravovania

eligible [elɪdʒəbl] – spôsobilý

emotional intelligence – emocionálna inteligencia

to enlarge [ɪn'la:dʒ] – zväčšiť

expectation – očakávanie

extreme case – extrémny prípad

to face – čeliť

facial hair [feɪʃl] – ochlpenie na tvári

hip – bok

help line – linka pomoci

in order to – aby, za účelom

juvenile crime [dʒu:vənəɪl] – zločiny mládeže

to kick out – vyhodiť

to lead to [li:d] – viesť k

legal right [li:gl] – zákonom dané právo

matter – vec, záležitosť

mature [mə'tʃʊə(r)] – zrelý

muscle mass [mʌsl mæs] – svalová hmota

to neglect [nɪ'glekt] – zanedbávať

to be obsessed (with) – byť posadnutý (čím)

obsession [əb'seʃn] – posadnutosť

to obtain – získať

to overeat – prejedat' sa

overprotective – úzkostlivý, príliš ochraňujúci

peer – vrstovník

pregnancy – tehotenstvo

to progress – postupovať

racial prejudice [reɪʃl prədʒʊdɪs] – rasový predsudok

responsible (for) – zodpovedný (za)

to search for – hľadať

secondary sex characteristics – druhotné pohlavné znaky

security – bezpečnosť

stage – štádium, etapa

sufferer – trpiaci

to take on – prevziať
tension [tenʃn] – napätie
unemployment – nezamestnanosť
unique identity [aɪ'dentəti] – jedinečná identita
unstable [ʌn'steɪbl] – nestabilný
value – hodnota
to vomit – vracať
weight loss – úbytok hmotnosti

welfare worker – sociálny pracovník
to widen [waɪdn] – rozšíriť
to go through changes – prejsť zmenami
to put on weight – pribrať
to struggle to fit – snažiť sa zapadnúť
to trust the authorities [ɔ:'θɒrəti:s] – veriť autoritám
under pressure – pod tlakom

□ VOCABULARY PRACTICE

Task 1 Which of the following adjectives best describe the feelings and moods of teenagers? Why?

*independent – ambitious – unstable – worried – busy – greedy – puzzled –
 addicted – tired – overprotective – careless – frustrated – mature –
 easygoing – prejudiced – secure – responsible – stressed – lazy – hardwork-
 ing – reluctant – sympathetic – depressed – cheerful – confused – deman-
 ding – tolerant – patient – respectful – naive – satisfied – inhibited –
 moody – amicable – self-reliant – stubborn – self-conscious – weird*

Task 2 Fill in the missing prepositions into the following expressions.

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Example: to fall in love with someone

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|--|---|
| 1. to go _____ physical and mental changes | 11. to suffer _____ eating disorders |
| 2. to feel _____ pressure | 12. to become addicted _____ drugs |
| 3. to look _____ security | 13. to break _____ (when a relationship ends) |
| 4. to identify _____ role models | 14. to care _____ own appearance |
| 5. to differ _____ clothing and hairstyle | 15. to rebel _____ society |
| 6. to search _____ a unique identity | 16. to bring _____ children |
| 7. to depend _____ parents | 17. to take _____ adult responsibilities |
| 8. to argue _____ siblings | 18. to be obsessed _____ oneself |
| 9. to get _____ with peers | 19. to live _____ one's own |
| 10. to differ _____ opinions | 20. to ask somebody _____ |